

SHOE BOX PLANT

Plants need food for the same reasons you do: to stay alive and grow. But, unlike you, plants create their own food, using energy from the sun. In this experiment, you'll see just how important sunlight is to a plant. You will challenge a bean seedling to find its way through a maze made inside a dark box, following just the tiniest beam of light. It won't take you long to set up the experiment, but you'll have to wait for the results. Even the speediest bean needs a few days to grow!

REACHING FOR THE LIGHT

You'll be impressed by the way your plant solves the maze. In its unstoppable search for light, it bends to and fro like a snake as it clambers upward. This is because the two sides of its stem grow at different rates, depending on the amount of light they receive.

